

my head and breathe in the crisp late fall air. By nine thirty a.m., I sat down at my computer to begin the book you're now reading.

Did I always have a passion for writing? No. Was writing a book, *another* personal finance book at that, my life's dream? No! But it is the thing that I most want to be doing with my life right now.

This is the book that I have been seeking for the past fifteen years and have not been able to find. I didn't decide I wanted to write this book. I became convinced that I *needed* to. This is the book that could have saved me six, if not seven, figures in financial mistakes and years of angst and unhappiness that I experienced on the path to FI because I was pursuing the wrong things. I am confident it will change your life.

FI is not about retiring early or retiring at all really. It's all about having the freedom and flexibility to design *your* life in alignment with *your* values. You can work on things important to you. You can work at your own pace. Or you can choose not to work at all. FI gives you the power to decide. It allows you to use your money as a tool to live a rich life, freeing yourself from the need to go to a job.

Building wealth that enables FI is simple, but it's not easy. There is a diverse group of people featured in this book who have